



The Lantern Helpers: Recount and Find a Lesson

Grade 2 • Michigan • Reading

RL.2.2

Recount an original story and connect its central lesson to key events. Includes 16 practice tasks, a four-task exit check, two explained models, and complete answer guidance.

PRINT • TEACH • REVISIT



Plan a focused lesson

Level and alignment

Grade 2 • Michigan • Reading; RL.2.2. Focus: Recount an original story and connect its central lesson to key events.

What is included

One cover; one teacher guide; one mini-lesson with two explained models; 1 original text/reference section(s); 16 practice tasks on four pages; one four-task exit check; four answer-key pages covering all 20 tasks; two access/source/license pages. Student texts are original, not extracted from released tests.

Time and sequence

Two 30–40-minute sessions plus a 10–15-minute exit check; extended writing or speech rehearsal may take longer. Model first; use tasks 1–4 to check readiness; practice the remainder in short groups; give tasks 17–20 without the key.

Preparation

Print student pages separately from teacher pages. Provide pencils and extra paper; oral-response learners need an adult recorder. Review word meanings and prerequisite decoding or sentence skills. No paid app, novel, or external reading is required.

Student directions

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.



Learn the move

A topic is a short label, such as helping. A lesson is an idea a reader can use, such as asking for help can solve a problem. Retell the main events before naming the lesson. This original realistic story gives focused practice; it is not a folktale or a complete study of the standard's range of cultures and genres.

Model 1 • A character shares a pencil, and both children finish. What lesson fits?

Sharing can help people succeed. The successful result supports that lesson.

Model 2 • Is “a pencil” a lesson?

No. It names an object, not a useful idea learned from events.

Try the task first. Then compare the reasoning, not just the final word.



The Lantern Helpers

Pia wanted to make a paper lantern for the class display. She cut a long strip, but it curled into a tight tube. She pulled it flat. It curled again.

"I can hold one end," said Ren.

"I want to do it myself," Pia replied. She tried to tape both ends with one hand. The tape stuck to her sleeve.

Ren waited beside her. Pia looked at the sticky sleeve and began to laugh. "Please hold this side." Ren held the paper while Pia placed the tape. The lantern stayed round.

Ren picked up a second strip. "Now mine keeps curling." Pia held it steady.

Together they finished two lanterns. Pia wrote both names on the display card. Her lantern was still her idea, but the work no longer had to be hers alone.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

1. What does Pia want to make?

2. What makes the task difficult?

3. What help does Ren first offer?

4. Why does Pia first refuse?



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

5. What happens to the tape?

6. What does Pia do before asking for help?

7. How does Ren help solve the problem?

8. How does Pia later help Ren?



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

9. Order: Pia helps Ren; tape sticks; Ren offers help.

10. Retell the beginning in one sentence.

11. Retell the middle in one sentence.

12. Retell the ending in one sentence.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

13. Choose a lesson: Work must always be alone; Help can make a hard job easier.

14. Which event best supports that lesson?

15. Why does the card with both names matter?

16. Explain how Pia changes.



Exit check • Apply the skill

Try without the answer key. Show evidence or reasoning when asked. Use separate paper for longer responses.

17. Name the main problem.

18. Name the action that solves it.

19. State a lesson as a full sentence.

20. Retell three key events in order to support your lesson.



Answers and response criteria

1. A paper lantern for the class display.
2. The strip curls and she cannot easily hold both ends while taping.
3. To hold one end.
4. She wants to do it herself.
5. It sticks to her sleeve.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

6. Looks at her sleeve and laughs.
7. Holds the paper while Pia tapes it.
8. Holds Ren's curling strip steady.
9. Ren offers help; tape sticks; Pia helps Ren.
10. Pia tries to make a lantern but the paper curls.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

11. She first refuses help, then asks Ren to hold the paper.
12. They help each other finish two lanterns and Pia writes both names.
13. Help can make a hard job easier; the lanterns are finished after cooperation.
14. Ren holds the paper so Pia can tape it; accept the matching later event with Pia helping.
15. Pia recognizes that both children helped, showing her change.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

16. From insisting on working alone to asking for and giving help, supported by these actions.

17. Curling paper makes the lantern hard to tape alone.

18. One child holds the paper while the other tapes.

19. Accept a supported idea about cooperation or accepting help, not only the topic "lanterns."

20. Pia struggles/refuses help; Ren holds paper after she asks; Pia helps Ren and credits both. Other accurate sequences accepted.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Access and next teaching steps

AIG

Ask for a counterexample, an alternative supported interpretation, or a newly written item with an explanation. Add depth rather than speed.

504

Follow the individual plan: breaks, enlarged print, extra time, reduced copying, or an alternative response method as documented. These are classroom options, not a statement of permitted test accommodations.

EC

Follow the IEP; show one task at a time, model the first decision, and permit dictated reasoning when appropriate. For decoding practice, distinguish an adult-read direction from an adult-read target word.

ESL

Preview task verbs and key vocabulary, allow home-language planning, and offer “My answer is ___ because ___.” Evaluate the targeted skill separately from unrelated language errors. For French, retain the target French sentence while explaining directions in a familiar language.

Use the exit evidence

For each exit task, record 2 = accurate and complete for the stated prompt; 1 = partly accurate or missing a requested explanation; 0 = not yet demonstrated. Total 0–8 is a local teaching note, not a standardized score. For oral tasks do not penalize spelling or handwriting. Revisit the exact type of error rather than assigning a diagnostic label.

Next lesson: model one missed decision, let the learner try a new example, and compare the explanation. Extend only after the learner can explain the targeted skill.

Alignment, sources, and license

The objective is original wording describing a focused part of the cited standard; this is not a full curriculum or official practice test.

Official state standard • accessed September 15, 2026

https://www.michigan.gov/-/media/Project/Websites/mde/Literacy/Content-Standards/ELA_Standards.pdf

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